

MRK18 · BUILD PLAN

Auto-Posting & Connected-Account Plan

LinkedIn / X / Reddit posting, ad-data fetch, and a plan-ahead scheduler — what the user must grant, what's real, and the smallest path to a credible 10-user demo.

Prepared 23 June 2026 · AI-CMO · LinkedIn + X first, via Ayrshare · approve-then-auto

MRK18 — Auto-Posting & Connected-Account Plan

Live research (Jun 2026) on LinkedIn / X / Reddit posting + ad-data fetch + a plan-ahead scheduler, scoped to the **10-user, investor-ready** MVP. Vision researched: *founder connects account → system fetches ad/performance data → analyzes → weekly refresh → founder plans a 10/20/30-day calendar once → the **ad_copy** AI adapter drafts → system auto-publishes.*

The one mental-model fix

Posting ≠ Reading their ad data. They are two different products, with two different approvals, at very different difficulty:

- **Posting on their behalf** → *easy / instant* (LinkedIn personal feed needs only a self-serve

scope, no review).

- **Reading their past ad campaigns** → *hard / slow* → a **separate** API (LinkedIn

Marketing/Advertising API) behind a **formal approval that takes weeks-to-months**, and only works if the founder actually has an ad account and grants a role.

So the hardest assumption — *"connect → instantly auto-fetch all past ad history and analyze"* — is the one part that **isn't instantly possible**. The posting and the AI drafting (the **ad_copy** adapter) are the easy parts.

What you need FROM the user, per platform

Platform	To POST for them	To READ their data	Prerequisite they must have	Instant?
LinkedIn	OAuth: w_member_social + openid / profile (self-serve, no review)	Ad data needs r_ads + r_ads_reporting + Marketing API approval (weeks-months) . Personal post-analytics API is closed .	An ad account (for ad data); a Company Page + admin role (for org posting)	Posting  · Ad data 
X (Twitter)	Paid API — pay-per-use: \$0.015/post, \$0.20 if it has a link	Reads \$0.005 each (Free tier = no reads)	A billing relationship (yours or theirs)	 but paid
Reddit	OAuth: identity + submit + read ; mandatory app pre-approval since Nov 2025	Reddit Ads API = separate allow-list	Account with sufficient age + karma or posts auto-removed	 ban-risky

Your vision, point by point — what's real

1. **"Auto-fetch all past ad history on connect"** →  **Not on day one**. Needs the separate

ad-API approval (LinkedIn: weeks-months) + the founder must have an ad account. **For the demo:** pull *organic* post performance (available) + offer a **one-time manual CSV import** of past ad data. Make live ad-ingestion a *roadmap* item, not an MVP blocker.

1. **"Weekly real-time fetch"** →  **Doable** (a recurring background job). Caveats: tokens need

refresh, and ~once a year the user must **re-connect** (refresh tokens expire); X reads cost money; LinkedIn personal analytics has no API.

1. **"Plan 10/20/30 days once, then auto-post"** →  ****Yes** — as "approve-then-auto," not

unattended. **The founder approves the whole calendar** once*; the system auto-publishes on schedule with an edit/pause window. Fully unattended posting violates ToS and gets accounts banned. It's also the better investor story.

1. **"Reddit auto-post"** →  **Don't**. Reddit's anti-spam rules name automation as a violation,

~96% of manipulation is auto-detected, and the banned account is **your customer's**. Do **draft-and-assist** (AI writes Reddit-native posts + suggests subreddits; the human posts).

What you're missing (the addons the research surfaced)

- **X costs real money now** — the **\$0.20-per-link-post** detail is brutal for a marketing tool

(a post linking to their site is 13× a plain post). Put it in your unit economics.

- **Reddit needs app pre-approval** (since Nov 2025) *and* the founder's account needs karma/age —

screen it at connect time.

- **LinkedIn personal post analytics API is closed** — you cannot read "how my posts performed" via

API. Org Pages can, with approval.

- **Yearly re-consent** — refresh tokens die at ~365 days; build a "reconnect LinkedIn" nudge.
- **DPDP (India)**: storing their OAuth tokens + audience data makes you a Data Fiduciary → need

consent + encryption (you have the vault) + a **data-processing agreement** with any vendor.

- **AI-content disclosure** — EU labeling rules land Aug 2026; add a disclosure toggle now.
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The architecture — you already have ~80%

Your backend already has the hard parts: the **arq cron worker**, the **encrypted token vault**, **idempotent publishing** (`request_id` + a unique constraint), and the **Gate-2 signed-approval** machinery (re-verified at publish time). To build the full vision you only need:

1. A `content_calendar` + `scheduled_posts` table (the calendar).
2. A **"publish due posts" cron** — runs every minute, claims due rows

(`status='scheduled' AND scheduled_at ≤ now()` , `FOR UPDATE SKIP LOCKED`), publishes, idempotent via `request_id` .

1. A **weekly per-account fetch cron** — feeds the existing `signals` / `analytics_diagnoses` tables.
2. A `refresh_access_token()` function — the one genuine gap (the vault stores refresh tokens

but there's no refresh-exchange yet).

1. **One publisher adapter** (you have stubs).

Net: two cron jobs, one table, one function, one adapter — and every brand-safety guarantee (signed approvals, publish-time re-verification, fast revocation) is preserved unchanged.

Suggested data model:

- `content_calendar(calendar_id, founder_id, run_id, name, horizon_days, timezone, approval_state, approved_at, ...)`
 - `scheduled_posts(scheduled_post_id, founder_id, calendar_id, item_id, platform, scheduled_at[UTC], status, approval_state, approval_event_id, request_id[unique], attempts, next_attempt_at, last_error, publish_result_id, locked_at, ...)`
 - Add `connected_accounts.last_metrics_fetch_at` (the weekly-fetch cursor). `signals` + `analytics_diagnoses` need no changes.
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Build vs buy

Provider	LinkedIn + X + Reddit posting	Analytics	Skips per-platform approval?	Self-host	Pricing
Ayrshare	Yes	Yes (organic; verify ad reporting)	Yes — posts under their approvals	No (SaaS)	Premium \$149/mo · Business ~\$499–599/mo (~30 profiles)
Postiz (OSS)	Yes (28+)	Limited	No — you bring your own apps	Yes	Free self-host
Mixpost (OSS)	Yes	Basic	No	Yes	One-time license
Phyllo	Read-only analytics — no publishing	Yes	n/a	No	SaaS

Why buy for the pilot: LinkedIn posting-to-Pages and ad data sit behind partner approvals (weeks-to-months, sometimes \$10k–50k/yr for partnerships); X is now pay-per-use/Enterprise; only Reddit is genuinely easy to build direct. A unified provider gets you LinkedIn + X posting **under their approvals** in days. **Caveat:** verify Ayrshare's *paid-ad* reporting coverage before promising ad-data features — deep ad reporting is sometimes still gated by the ad platform even via a vendor.

Recommendation — the 10-user, investor-ready MVP

1. **Build vs buy** → **BUY Ayrshare** for the pilot (~\$149–599/mo). Your adapters are already a pluggable `Protocol`, so an `AyrshareAdapter` drops in; go direct later at scale. Sign a DPA.

1. **Platforms first** → **LinkedIn personal posting** (instant, best for B2B founders) **+ X pay-per-use (**no monthly minimum**). Skip Reddit auto-post at launch** (draft-and-assist only).

1. **Model** → **approve-the-calendar-once** → **auto-publish with an edit/pause window** (reuses Gate-2).

2. **Analytics** → **organic now; ad-data = roadmap + one-time manual CSV import** for the demo.

This ships in days, won't get your design partners banned, is DPDP-defensible (encrypt tokens + consent + DPA), and tells a clean "autonomous CMO" story to investors.

Sources

- LinkedIn — Share on LinkedIn (self-serve `w_member_social`); Sign In with OpenID Connect; Posts API; Community Management app review; Marketing/Advertising API tiers; programmatic refresh tokens; API rate limits; API Terms of Use (Microsoft Learn / LinkedIn Legal).
- X / Twitter — API pricing 2026 (pay-per-use \$0.015/post, \$0.20/link-post; legacy Basic/Pro closed to new signups); X automation development rules.
- Reddit — Responsible Builder Policy (mandatory pre-approval, Nov 2025); Spam / self-promotion policy; OAuth2 scopes + submit endpoint + User-Agent rules; Reddit Ads API allow-list.
- Architecture — arq docs; Postiz / Mixpost scheduler patterns; distributed-job-scheduler best practices (two-tier cold/hot, idempotency keys, FOR UPDATE SKIP LOCKED).
- Build vs buy — Ayrshare pricing & docs; unified social-API comparisons (Buffer, Outstand); Phyllo (analytics-only); Unipile (LinkedIn-centric).
- Compliance — India DPDP Act 2023 + Rules 2025 (notified Nov 2025); EU AI Act Article 50 / AI-content labeling Code of Practice (Aug 2026).